

Circular Light Rail

Kaohsiung's 22.1 km Circular Light Rail, whose second phase was delayed by route and streetscape disputes before the 38-station loop opened in 2024.

THE LINE



NOT ESTABLISHED

C CIRCULAR LIGHT RAIL LINE 環狀輕軌			
STATION COUNT 38 ^[3]	GOVERNMENT ROUTE LENGTH 22.1 ^[3]	SYSTEM TYPE surface light rail ^[3]	APPROVED CONSTRUCTION COST 211.16 ^[4]
FULL-LINE FORMAL OPERATION 2024-02-26 ^[7]	TDX KRTC METRO COVERAGE No LRT records in the committed Metro pull ^[9]		

Scope and built form

Kaohsiung's Circular Light Rail is a 22.1 km surface-light-rail loop with 38 stations in the city government's completed-route description.^[3] Its alignment uses the former harbour-rail corridor, port roads, Pier-2, the west-side railway corridor, the Museum of Fine Arts area and Dashun roads before returning through the south-western corridor.^[3] The operator's English guide map lists the same C1–C37 plus C21A station identity, while the current TDX Metro pull contains only the Red and Orange metro lines.^{[1] [9]}

The approved planning page gives a combined construction cost of NT\$211.16 billion, including NT\$70.13 billion in central support and NT\$141.03 billion borne by the city, including self-financing revenue.^[4] It describes a surface B-type right of way with the track separated from the road, 1,435 mm standard gauge, 100% low-floor vehicles, and platforms 2.5–4 m wide and 35 cm high.^[4] The government route page lists transfers to the Red Line at C3 and C24, to the Orange Line at C14 and C32, and to TRA at C18 and C30.^[3]

Two-phase construction and delay

The approved plan divided construction because the C17–C20 railway-garden section depended on the Kaohsiung urban railway-undergrounding project, while the C32–C36 corridor depended on the release of land from the Taiwan Railways East Harbour Line.^[4] Phase 1 was defined as 8.7 km from the Qianzhen shunting yard to Sizihwan, while Phase 2 covered the remaining 13.4 km.^[4] The planning page's original schedule expected Phase 1 to finish by the end of ROC year 106 and Phase 2 to follow the 2017 railway-undergrounding schedule; those are planning milestones, not the eventual opening dates.^[4]

The second phase became a public dispute rather than a routine continuation. DORTS says the route had been planned since the 1990s, but when construction entered the site in ROC year 106, residents repeatedly protested the route and construction method.^[5] The city published five "reassurance" measures in July 2018, but opposition continued, and the mayor announced on 18 January 2019 that the disputed second-phase works should pause for broader public hearings.^[5]

DORTS then held five public hearings in February and March 2019 and recorded 1,874 opinion forms.^[5] The support submissions cited accessibility, relief of road and commercial-area congestion and connections to the Red and Orange lines; the opposition submissions cited lower capacity, slower speed, traffic effects, loss of curb parking and a preference for underground or elevated metro.^[5] The bureau appointed nine rail and transport experts to examine nine alternatives, including the original alignment and method, elevated, underground, a Tongmeng Road diversion, C-type right of way and cancellation.^[5]

The expert committee's recommendations retained the southern noncontroversial section, proposed resident participation and human-centred streetscape treatment for the Art Museum Road and Dashun Road section, and suggested a future northward extension toward Taiwan High Speed Rail [\[/rail/thsr/lines/thsr/\]](/rail/thsr/lines/thsr/) Zuoying [\[/rail/thsr/stations/zuoying/\]](/rail/thsr/stations/zuoying/).^[5] DORTS said the committee judged elevated or underground alternatives less economically suitable because of cost, construction risk and later operation, but that is the bureau's account of the committee's assessment rather than an independent finding by this page.^[5]

Environmental revision and completion

The 2021 environmental-difference review recorded more than 44 public briefings and 20 expert meetings before the city retained the basic route with design changes.^[6] Those changes included a larger curve radius, moving the Art Museum Road alignment north, preserving four road lanes, adding C21A, adding a pedestrian bridge for Chung-Hua Arts School and placing a station in the United Hospital setback.^[6] DORTS said the changes reduced noise, preserved emergency access and road service, and did not increase environmental impacts compared with the approved environmental assessment.^[6]

KRTC's current operator Q&A records the result as a 1 January 2024 full-circle trial with service expanded to all 38 stations, followed by formal full-line operation from 26 February.^[7] It also records the change from a flat fare to distance-based charging and identifies C1 as both termini for the circular service.^[7] The planning schedule and the operating record therefore show a clear conflict between the original 2017-era completion expectation and the actual 2024 full-line service date; neither is silently substituted for the other.^[4] ^[7]

Station sequence and data boundary

The government station table contains C1 through C37 plus C21A, so C21A Neiwei Arts Center and C21 Kaohsiung Museum of Fine Arts remain separate records.^[3] The operator's current timetable page uses some updated English and Chinese naming, including C26 Dashun Minzu and parenthetical names at C27 and C31, so the station layer retains the operator and government provenance rather than manufacturing a single "corrected" translation.^[2] ^[1] ^[3]

The government and operator pages establish station identities, locations, loop structure, construction scope, route length, built form, formal operation and listed interchanges.^[1] ^[2] ^[3] ^[4] ^[7] TDX's committed KRTC Metro dataset does not contain the LRT as a Metro line, so this page does not invent TDX LRT geometry or station ridership from the metro pull.^[9] ^[10] Detailed station accessibility, platform coordinates, observed ridership, rolling-stock allocation, power substations and package-level construction costs remain TBC until their primary records are fetched and transcribed.^[8] ^[7]

Ridership

TBC. No ridership series has been imported for this operator. The page keeps the figure TBC rather than borrowing another operator's data.

References

10 of 10 sources on this page are primary — published by the operator, the builder or government.

- 1 **KRTC guide map** [https://www.krtc.com.tw/eng/KLRT/guide_map]
導覽圖

PRIMARY Kaohsiung Rapid Transit Corporation (高雄捷運股份有限公司) accessed 2026-08-24

The operator's English guide map lists the Red, Orange and Circular Light Rail station names and codes.

- 2 **KRTC Circular Light Rail timetable station list** [<https://www.krtc.com.tw/KLRT/timetable>]
各車站時刻表

PRIMARY Kaohsiung Rapid Transit Corporation (高雄捷運股份有限公司) accessed 2026-08-24

The operator page lists the 38 Circular Light Rail codes and Traditional Chinese names.

- 3 **Circular Light Rail route description** [<https://mtbu.kcg.gov.tw/KaohsiungMetro/CompletedRoutes/LightRail/LightRail01.html>]
路線說明

PRIMARY Kaohsiung City Government Mass Rapid Transit Bureau (高雄市政府捷運工程局) accessed 2026-08-24

The government project page gives the circular alignment, every station's Traditional Chinese name and location, 22.1 km length, 38 stations, surface-light-rail type and listed transfers.

- 4 **Circular Light Rail planning explanation** [<https://mtbu.kcg.gov.tw/KaohsiungMetro/ApprovedRoutes/LightRail/LightRail0202.html>]
規劃說明

PRIMARY Kaohsiung City Government Mass Rapid Transit Bureau (高雄市政府捷運工程局) accessed 2026-08-25

The full planning page gives the approved combined cost, funding split, built form, gauge, vehicle form and the 8.7 km/13.4 km two-phase construction boundary.

- 5 **Response on the Phase 2 Circular Light Rail delay** [<https://mtbu.kcg.gov.tw/Activities/C002100?CategoryID=ee7b8b6d-03c0-4e8f-b133-e0a7c97fa933&PageType=1&id=35f1845d-588f-4cce-b857-d6dafad25662>]
高雄環狀輕軌二階美術館路及大順路段延宕回應說明

PRIMARY Kaohsiung City Government Mass Rapid Transit Bureau (高雄市政府捷運工程局) accessed 2026-08-25

The full 2020 DORTS response records the 1990s planning history, 2017 protests, 2019 pause, five public hearings, 1,874 opinion forms and the nine-option expert review.

- 6 **Circular Light Rail environmental-difference report approved** [<https://mtbu.kcg.gov.tw/Activities/C002100?CategoryID=ee7b8b6d-03c0-4e8f-b133-e0a7c97fa933&Keyword=%E6%A8%B9&PageNumber=4&PageType=1&id=a5b4517e-8be6-4df0-a0cf-e1f7c81129d4>]
高雄輕軌環境影響差異分析報告 環評委員審查通過

PRIMARY Kaohsiung City Government Mass Rapid Transit Bureau (高雄市政府捷運工程局) accessed 2026-08-25

The full 2021 DORTS release records environmental-review approval, more than 44 public briefings, 20 expert meetings, route optimization and the addition of C21A.

- 7 **Kaohsiung Light Rail riding and fare Q&A** [https://www.krtc.com.tw/Service/faq_more?id=10def821c28c4466a394be86edca7383]

高雄輕軌乘車及票價Q&A

PRIMARY Kaohsiung Rapid Transit Corporation (高雄捷運股份有限公司) accessed 2026-08-25

The full current operator Q&A records the 1 January 2024 circle trial, 38-station service and 26 February 2024 formal full-line operation, plus the distance-based fare change.

8 KRTC station information [https://www.krtc.com.tw/eng/KLRT/station_guide]

各車站資訊

PRIMARY Kaohsiung Rapid Transit Corporation (高雄捷運股份有限公司) accessed 2026-08-24

The operator's English station-guide page exposes metro and light-rail station information and the accessibility/safety navigation.

9 TDX Kaohsiung Metro line records [<https://tdx.transportdata.tw/api/basic/v2/Rail/Metro/Line/KRTC?%24format=JSON&%24top=1000&%24skip=0>]

高雄捷運路線資料

PRIMARY Ministry of Transportation and Communications, TDX (交通部運輸資料流通服務平臺)

accessed 2026-08-24

The live pull contains the two line identities returned for KRTC: R and O.

10 TDX Kaohsiung Metro line shapes [<https://tdx.transportdata.tw/api/basic/v2/Rail/Metro/Shape/KRTC?%24format=JSON&%24top=1000&%24skip=0>]

高雄捷運路線幾何資料

PRIMARY Ministry of Transportation and Communications, TDX (交通部運輸資料流通服務平臺)

accessed 2026-08-24

The live pull contains two current metro geometry records, one for each line.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.